succession.

1916. Frederic Clements coins the term “climax community” for the process of stabilisation over time in ecological communities.

1957. The first satellite goes into space, heralding new technologies in wildlife tracking.

1967. The concept of the “ecological guild” is introduced in Richard B. Root’s thesis on the blue-grey gnatcatcher.

1975. Citizen science enables Fred and Norah Urquhart to discover where monarch butterflies go in winter.

1976. Robert May applies chaos theory to predicting rates of growth and decline in animal population dynamics.

1988. John Odling-Smee suggests that “niche constructors” actively change their environment.

1989. James H. Brown and Robert Maurer devise the concept of macroecology, in which